

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

Count Herds, Understand Systems

What leaders should authorize, require, and refuse

Production Unit	PU-B07-C18
Decision status	Controlled learning asset
Audience	Executives, programme owners, statisticians, technical leads
Data	Synthetic examples only

Executive takeaway: Analyse livestock by production system, mobility, species, ownership, season, and denominator rather than relying on undifferentiated animal counts.

Why it matters

Animal counts alone can conceal mobility, ownership concentration, production purpose, mortality, and seasonal availability.

Illustrative application

A livestock indicator distinguishes herd size from livestock-owning households and records transhumant mobility and reference season.

Minimum approval conditions

- Named accountable owner and lawful purpose
- Defined evidence, provenance, reference period, population, and geography
- Decision-relevant validation and visible uncertainty
- Documented abstention, referral, override, and incident processes
- Accessibility, equity, security, retention, and retirement review

Non-negotiable boundary

The analytical system may inform review. It may not independently authorize benefits, sanctions, enforcement, clinical treatment, school exclusion, displacement, or another consequential action.